

MIRITINI RESPONSE TEAM CONSTITUTION.

The official name of the group shall be MIRITINI RESPONSE TEAM. This name shall be used in all official documents, communications, registrations, and activities carried out by the group.

STATUS AND DESCRIPTION:

MIRITINI RESPONSE TEAM is a self-help group formed by members of the community disaster management committee (CDMC) under the Kenya Red Cross with the aim of working together to address social, economic, and environmental challenges.

The group focuses on:

Disaster preparedness and response.

Community development.

Youth empowerment.

Social support and outreach programs.

It operates on principles of teamwork, voluntary participation, and collective responsibility, where members contribute ideas, time, and resources to improve both their own lives and the wider community.

VISION:

To build a resilient, empowered, and self-reliant community that is capable of effectively responding to disasters and improving the quality of life for all its members.

This vision reflects the long-term aspiration of the group to create a strong and sustainable society where individuals are equipped with the knowledge, skills, and unity needed to overcome challenges.

MISSION:

The mission of the group is to empower youth and community members through organized activities, training, and programs that promote:

Disaster preparedness and response

Economic empowerment

Social development

Health and well-being

This will be achieved through continuous engagement, partnerships, and community-driven initiatives that directly address local needs.

CORE VALUES:

The group shall be guided by the following core values:

Respect

The group shall promote mutual respect among members regardless of gender, background, or opinion. Every member's voice shall be valued, and interactions shall be conducted with dignity and understanding.

Accountability

All members, especially leaders, shall take responsibility for their actions and decisions. Resources entrusted to the group shall be used properly, and leaders shall be answerable to members.

Transparency

The group shall ensure openness in all its operations, particularly in financial matters, decision-making, and communication, so that members remain informed and confident in the leadership.

Gender Equality

The group shall ensure equal participation and opportunity for all members, regardless of gender, and shall actively discourage discrimination.

Solidarity

Members shall stand together, support one another, and work as a team to achieve common goals, especially during times of need or crisis.

OBJECTIVES:

The objectives of the group shall be achieved through the following actions:

Youth empowerment

By organizing training programs, mentorship, and supporting members in accessing employment and entrepreneurship opportunities.

Community development

By identifying local needs and implementing projects such as environmental clean-ups and development initiatives.

Charitable support

Through fundraising, donations, and outreach to assist vulnerable groups.

Advocacy

By conducting awareness campaigns and engaging stakeholders on issues such as health, human rights, and governance.

Education and skills development

Through workshops on life skills, leadership, and financial literacy.

Income generation

By establishing group projects and savings initiatives to improve members' economic status.

Health awareness

Through programs on reproductive health, HIV prevention, and general well-being.

Disaster preparedness

By training members, conducting drills, and coordinating response efforts.

MEMBERSHIP AND ELIGIBILITY:

Membership shall be open to individuals who meet the following conditions:

Must be aged between 18 and 35 years

Must be of good character and willing to uphold the group's values

Must be recommended by at least five (5) existing members

Must pay a non-refundable registration fee of Ksh. 300

Membership is voluntary, but once admitted, members are expected to actively participate in group activities and responsibilities.

RIGHTS OF MEMBERS:

Every member shall have the right to:

Participate in decision-making processes

Vote and be voted into leadership positions

Access information, records, and reports of the group

Benefit from group programs and activities

Express opinions freely in meetings

OBLIGATIONS OF MEMBERS:

Members shall:

Adhere strictly to this constitution

Pay all required contributions on time

Attend meetings regularly and participate actively

Support group initiatives and decisions

Promote unity and avoid conflicts within the group

CESSATION OF MEMBERSHIP:

Membership may end through:

Death

Voluntary withdrawal (with 30 days' notice)

Expulsion due to misconduct

Any member leaving the group must first clear all financial obligations.

DISCIPLINE:

Disciplinary action may be taken against members who:

Violate the constitution

Fail to meet financial obligations

Engage in criminal or unethical behavior

Act against the interests of the group

All disciplinary actions shall follow a fair process where the member is given a chance to respond.

FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT

SOURCES OF FUNDS

The group's funds shall be derived from:

Registration fees

Monthly member contributions

Donations and grants

Income-generating activities

Fundraising events

Loans from recognized financial institutions (subject to approval)

CONTRIBUTIONS

Registration fee: Ksh. 300(non-refundable, paid once upon joining)

Monthly contribution: Ksh. 200

Any additional contributions shall be approved by members during a meeting.

FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT AND CONTROL

All funds belonging to the group shall be:

Properly recorded

Used strictly for approved group activities

The Treasurer shall:

Maintain accurate financial records

Keep receipts and supporting documents for all transactions

Present financial reports regularly to members

No funds shall be spent without:

Approval by the leadership, and

Proper documentation

BANKING AND SIGNATORIES

All group funds shall be kept in a recognized financial institution in the name of the group.

The account shall have the following signatories:

Chairperson

Secretary

Treasurer

NB: The Treasurer and Secretary are a mandatory requirement to be present during the withdrawal of money from the account or during any other transactions.

In case they are absent, The assistants can fill in for them or any member of the leadership committee

FINANCIAL REPORTING

The Treasurer shall present:

Monthly financial reports to members

Annual financial reports during the AGM

Members shall have the right to:

Access financial records upon reasonable request

MISUSE OF FUNDS

Any member or official found to have misused group funds shall:

Be required to refund the full amount

Face disciplinary action, including possible removal from office or expulsion

ASSETS AND PROPERTY

All assets acquired by the group shall:

Be recorded in an asset register

Be used only for group purposes

No member shall claim personal ownership of group property.

ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES OF OFFICE BEARERS:

1. CHAIRPERSON

The Chairperson shall be the overall leader of the group and shall:

Provide strategic direction and leadership to ensure the group achieves its objectives

Preside over all general and committee meetings and ensure they are conducted in an orderly and fair manner

Act as the official representative and spokesperson of the group in all external matters

Ensure that all decisions made by members and the leadership are implemented effectively

Supervise and coordinate the work of all other officials

Promote unity, discipline, and cooperation among members

Ensure adherence to this constitution and guide members on its interpretation

Have a casting vote in case of a tie during decision-making

Work closely with stakeholders, partners, and community leaders to advance the group's interests.

2. ASSISTANT CHAIRPERSON

The Assistant Chairperson shall support the Chairperson and shall:

Assist in carrying out leadership duties and coordination of group activities
Act on behalf of the Chairperson in their absence with full authority
Help monitor the performance of group projects and programs
Ensure effective communication between leadership and members
Support conflict resolution and promote harmony within the group
Take up any additional responsibilities assigned by the Chairperson or leadership.

3. SECRETARY

The Secretary shall be responsible for administration and documentation and shall:
Serve as the custodian of all group records, including the constitution, minutes, and official documents
Prepare and circulate meeting notices, agendas, and minutes
Record accurate minutes of all meetings and ensure proper documentation of decisions
Maintain and update the membership register
Handle official correspondence on behalf of the group
Ensure that important information is communicated to members in a timely manner
Work closely with the Chairperson to organize meetings and activities
Ensure safe storage and proper management of all group documents.

4. ASSISTANT SECRETARY

The Assistant Secretary shall support the Secretary and shall:
Assist in recording minutes and maintaining records
Act as Secretary in their absence
Help in managing communication within the group
Support administrative duties and documentation
Ensure continuity and efficiency in record-keeping processes.

5. TREASURER

The Treasurer shall be responsible for financial management and shall:
Receive, record, and safeguard all group funds
Maintain accurate and up-to-date financial records, including income and expenditure
Issue receipts for all payments received
Ensure that all financial transactions are properly documented and authorized
Prepare and present monthly and annual financial reports to members
Keep custody of financial documents such as receipts, bank slips, and records
Work with leadership to prepare budgets and financial plans
Ensure that group funds are used only for approved purposes
Report any financial irregularities immediately to the leadership
Be accountable for any loss of funds due to negligence.

6. ORGANIZING SECRETARY / PROGRAM MANAGER

The Organizing Secretary / Program Manager shall coordinate group activities and shall:
Plan, organize, and oversee all group programs, events, and projects
Develop activity schedules, work plans, and project timelines

- Coordinate implementation of group initiatives and ensure they run smoothly
- Mobilize members to participate actively in group activities
- Monitor and evaluate the progress of programs and report to leadership
- Work with other officials to ensure successful execution of group objectives
- Identify new opportunities for community engagement and development projects
- Ensure proper planning and organization of meetings, events, and outreach programs.

7. CHIEF OF ADVISORY

The Chief of Advisory shall provide guidance and oversight and shall:

- Offer strategic advice and counsel to the leadership and members
- Guide the group in decision-making to ensure alignment with its objectives
- Support conflict resolution among members and leadership
- Ensure that leadership actions are consistent with the constitution and best practices
- Act as a neutral and wise figure in resolving disputes
- Provide mentorship and guidance to leaders and members
- Help build external relationships and strengthen the group's credibility
- Participate in key discussions and provide recommendations without interfering in daily operations.

GENERAL MEETINGS

The group shall hold regular meetings once every week, on a day agreed upon by members. Members are expected to attend all meetings and actively participate in group activities. Any member who fails to attend three consecutive meetings without a valid reason may face disciplinary action as determined by the leadership. The leadership may impose reasonable penalties for lateness or absence, as approved by members. The leadership may call a meeting at any time where there is an urgent matter requiring attention.

QUORUM

A quorum for any general meeting shall be not less than one-half (1/2) of the registered members. No official business shall be conducted in the absence of a quorum. If quorum is not met, the meeting shall be postponed to a later date determined by the leadership.

ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING (AGM)

The group shall hold an Annual General Meeting once every year. The AGM shall:

- Review the group's activities and performance
- Receive and approve financial reports
- Discuss and approve major decisions
- Conduct elections where applicable

SPECIAL GENERAL MEETING (SGM)

A Special General Meeting may be convened:

By the leadership, or

Upon request by at least one-third (1/3) of the members

The purpose of the meeting shall be clearly stated before it is held.

DISCIPLINE AND IMPEACHMENT

DISCIPLINARY PROCEDURES

Any member or official accused of misconduct shall:

Be notified of the allegations

Be given an opportunity to respond

The leadership shall review the matter and make recommendations to members where necessary.

Disciplinary actions may include:

Warning

Suspension

Expulsion

IMPEACHMENT OF OFFICIALS

An elected official may be removed from office if they:

Fail to perform their duties effectively

Misuse group funds or property

Act against the interests of the group

Violate the constitution

IMPEACHMENT PROCEDURE

A motion for impeachment must be:

Proposed by at least one-third (1/3) of members

The official must be:

Informed of the allegations

Given a chance to defend themselves

Removal from office shall require a two-thirds (2/3) majority vote of members present.

BY-ELECTIONS

A by-election shall be conducted where:

An official is impeached

An official resigns or is unable to continue serving

An official fails to meet expectations as determined by members

COMMITTEE MEETINGS AND QUORUM

The leadership shall hold committee meetings regularly to plan and oversee group activities.
A quorum for committee meetings shall be at least two-thirds (2/3) of the elected officials.
Decisions made at committee meetings shall be by majority vote.
In case of a tie, the Chairperson shall have a casting vote.
Committee decisions must be reported to members during general meetings.

CODE OF CONDUCT

MEMBER CODE OF CONDUCT

All members of the group shall:

- Conduct themselves with integrity, respect, and honesty at all times
- Uphold and protect the name and reputation of the group
- Avoid any behavior that may bring conflict, division, or disrepute to the group
- Respect leadership decisions made in accordance with this constitution
- Promote unity, teamwork, and cooperation among members
- Refrain from misuse of group resources or authority

LEADERSHIP CODE OF CONDUCT

All elected officials shall:

- Act in the best interest of the group at all times
- Exercise fairness, transparency, and accountability in decision-making
- Avoid conflicts of interest and declare any personal interests where necessary
- Not use their positions for personal gain
- Be available, responsive, and committed to their responsibilities
- Lead by example and maintain high ethical standards

CONFLICT OF INTEREST

Any member or official with a personal interest in a matter being discussed must:
Declare the interest
Refrain from participating in decision-making on that matter

ENFORCEMENT OF CODE OF CONDUCT

Any violation of the code of conduct shall be subject to:
Review by the leadership
Appropriate disciplinary action as outlined in this constitution

ELECTIONS AND DISCIPLINE

Term: 2 years
By-elections allowed
Impeachment process clearly defined

DISSOLUTION AND AMENDMENTS

Dissolution: 3/4 majority
Amendments: 2/3 majority

DECLARATION

This constitution shall guide all operations of MIRITINI RESPONSE TEAM and shall take effect upon adoption.

Chairperson: _____ Sign: _____ Date: _____

Secretary: _____ Sign: _____ Date: _____